

The Finder also allows you to override a particular document-application link temporarily by holding down the Option key while you double-click the document. The Finder will present a Standard File dialog to allow you to open the document with a different application. The link will be temporary—only the selected documents will be opened using the application you choose. To make a new link permanent, hold down *both* Option and Control while you double-click a document; the Finder will forget the old application and remember that the new application should be used to open all documents of that type.

 Note!

The Option and Control-Option features only work when there's already a link in place for a specific kind of file. For example, Option-opening a font has no effect if the Finder doesn't already know that fonts should be opened with a particular application. (More specifically, the Finder doesn't create new links for unlinked documents, only update existing links.) To create links of your own, you need an application called an icon editor. Two popular icon editors are IconEd by Paul Elseth and DlcEd by Dave Lyons; both are shareware and are available from user groups, online services, and public-domain software distributors.

 Note!

BASIC Launcher
If you previously used System 5, the Finder may occasionally ask for an application called BASIC.Launcher when you try to launch BASIC programs. (Remember, the Finder considers BASIC programs to be documents for the BASIC application.) The BASIC.Launcher application is no longer present (or necessary) in System 6. Use the Locate button to re-link the BASIC program to BASIC.System. (Alternately, you can Duplicate the BASIC.System file and name the copy BASIC.Launcher; then the Finder will always be able to find BASIC.Launcher.)

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The Finder can also tell the application to print your document automatically. Just select the document(s), then select "Print" from the File menu. The Finder will launch the application and tell it to open your documents and print them.

 Note!

Some programs don't support automatically opening document files. Others support opening document files, but can't automatically print them. The SynthLab program that comes with System 6 is one of the former; the Teach mini-word processor is one of the latter.